



# Gotabgaa Australia

## National Structure & Governance Framework

Working document — June 2026

Unity • Heritage • Excellence

A **distinct Australian association** — operates independently of Gotabgaa International (USA)

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## 1. Executive Summary

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Gotabgaa Australia is the **national coordinating body** for Kalenjin community associations already operating across Australian states and territories. It is a **distinct association** that operates **independently** — not an affiliate, subsidiary, or chapter of Gotabgaa International (USA). It does not replace state associations. Instead, it provides a unified national identity, shared programs, financial coordination where appropriate, and a single voice for the Australian Kalenjin diaspora.

**Key message:** State associations own community life on the ground. National owns what only a country-wide body can do — unity across states, national programs, national brand, and representation of Gotabgaa Australia in Australia and abroad.

This document uses a federation model (national board + state chairs and representatives) suited to the Australian context, where associations already exist in NSW, Queensland, Victoria, South Australia, Western Australia, and other jurisdictions. Structural ideas may parallel other diaspora organisations (including the US-based [Gotabgaa International](#) website) for reference only — **with no governance, financial, or legal link to that body.**

## 2. Background & Context

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### 2.1 Reference model — Gotabgaa International (USA, separate organisation)

[Gotabgaa International](#) is a separate US-based non-profit (501(c)(3) in Georgia) registered in 2000. It is **not** the parent or governing body of Gotabgaa Australia. Its website describes a useful reference for how diaspora chapters can be organised — national leadership team, state chapters with Chairperson and Chapter REP, and an Oversight Council — but Australia adopts its own constitution, finances, and leadership.

### 2.2 Australian context

In Australia, Kalenjin community activity is already organised at state level — gatherings, sports days, welfare support, cultural events (including Taunet Nelel celebrations), and city-based networks in Sydney, Melbourne, Brisbane, Perth, Adelaide, and Canberra. A national body is needed to:

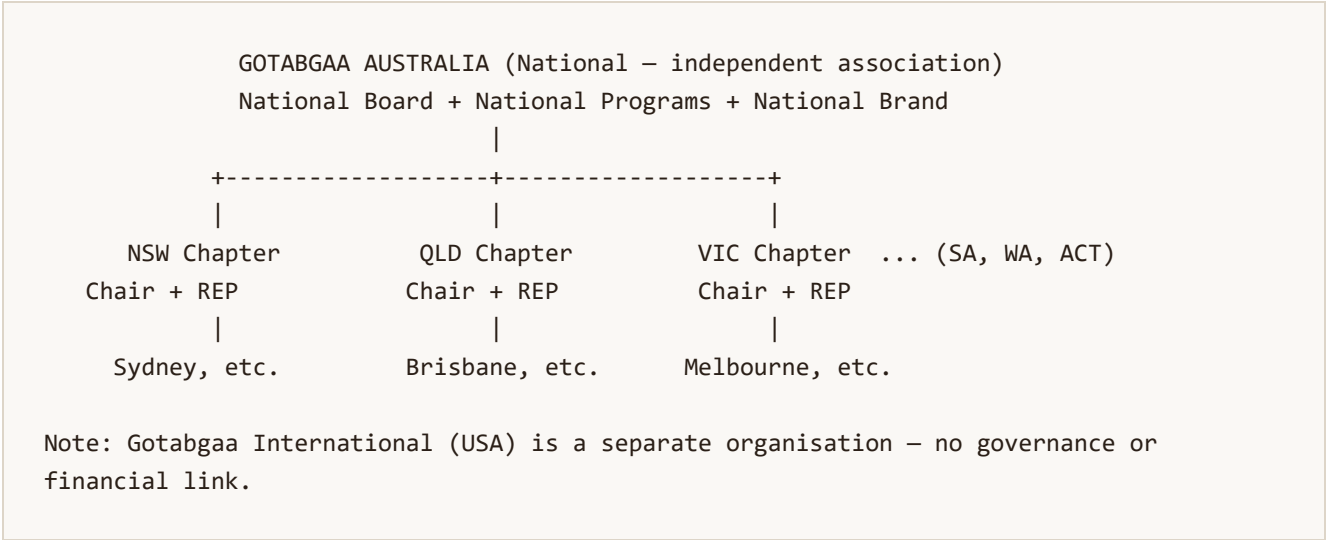
- Present one coherent “Gotabgaa Australia” identity domestically and internationally
- Coordinate cross-state events and national programs under Australian governance
- Prevent duplication, competition, and confusion between state groups
- Register and represent the national association under Australian law where appropriate
- Steward national-level funds (e.g. benevolence, scholarships) where pooling adds value

### 2.3 Legal status — independent association

Gotabgaa Australia should clarify its legal form (e.g. incorporated association under state law, or unincorporated federation with a lead state entity). Its **constitution and policies are authoritative for Australia only**. There is no affiliate agreement, reporting obligation, or shared treasury with Gotabgaa International. Members who also participate in other diaspora groups (including GI) do so in their personal capacity unless a separate voluntary arrangement exists.

### 3. Core Principle: Federation, Not Replacement

| Layer    | Reference (other diaspora models)                                         | Gotabgaa Australia                                                        |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National | Independent national board + programs (e.g. US GI structure — not linked) | <b>Gotabgaa Australia</b> — federation + national voice, fully autonomous |
| Chapter  | State chapters with Chair + REP                                           | <b>State/territory associations</b> (NSW, QLD, VIC, SA, WA, ACT, TAS, NT) |
| Local    | City sub-groups within chapters                                           | City networks (Sydney, Melbourne, Brisbane, etc.) under state chapters    |



## 4. Organisational Structure

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### 4.1 Three governing bodies

1. **National Leadership Board** — executive authority for Australia-wide decisions
2. **State & Territory Chapter Council** — all state Chairpersons and Chapter REPs
3. **National Oversight / Advisory Council** — elders, founders, cultural and pastoral advisors (non-executive)

### 4.2 Recommended leadership positions (national)

| Position                | Structural parallel         | Reports to                      |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| National President      | Board President (reference) | Chapter Council; members at AGM |
| National Vice President | Board Vice President        | National President              |
| Secretary General       | Board Secretary General     | National President              |
| National Coordinator    | National Coordinator        | National President              |
| National Treasurer      | Board Treasurer             | National President              |

### 4.3 Recommended leadership positions (each state chapter)

| Position                     | Structural parallel | Primary accountability                   |
|------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------|
| State Chairperson            | Chapter Chairperson | State members and state constitution     |
| Chapter Representative (REP) | Chapter REP         | National Chapter Council + state members |
| State Secretary (optional)   | —                   | State Chairperson                        |
| State Treasurer (optional)   | —                   | State Chairperson                        |

## 5. National Leadership Board — Roles & Responsibilities

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### 5.1 National President

- Chief spokesperson for Gotabgaa Australia domestically and internationally
- Chairs National Board meetings and Annual General Meeting (AGM)
- Sets annual priorities with the board; approves major national initiatives
- Represents Gotabgaa Australia to government, media, and community partners in Australia
- Ensures national activities remain non-political and non-partisan

### 5.2 National Vice President

- Acts for the President in absence; supports succession planning
- Leads cross-state initiatives (e.g. national cultural calendar, youth programs)
- Mediates between state chapters when coordination issues arise
- Supports membership growth and new chapter formation (e.g. ACT, TAS, NT)

### 5.3 Secretary General

- Maintains national constitution, policies, and official records
- Maintains correspondence with state chapters and external bodies in Australia
- Oversees national membership register (or coordinates with state registers)
- Prepares agendas, minutes, and annual reports for board and AGM
- Manages official email, document storage, and compliance filings

### 5.4 National Coordinator

- Coordinates national programs: education, benevolence, outreach, cultural fete
- Maintains master events calendar across all states
- Liaison between national board and state Chairpersons / REPs
- Tracks program outcomes (members served, funds disbursed, events held)
- Aligns Australian programs with national policy and member needs

### 5.5 National Treasurer

- Manages national bank accounts; maintains transparent financial records
- Oversees national benevolence fund, donations, and grant applications

- Prepares budgets and financial reports for board and AGM
- Defines financial rules for state chapters (reporting, pooling, audit)

## **5.6 Term limits and accountability (recommended)**

- Board terms: 2–3 years, staggered elections to retain continuity
- Maximum two consecutive terms per role (configurable in constitution)
- Annual performance review by Chapter Council (no-confidence pathway if needed)
- All officers subject to code of conduct and financial transparency rules

## 6. State & Territory Chapters

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### 6.1 Recognised chapters (initial list)

| Chapter                            | Typical cities                | Chairperson              | Chapter REP            |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|
| New South Wales (NSW)              | Sydney, Newcastle, Wollongong | <i>To be appointed</i>   | <i>To be appointed</i> |
| Queensland (QLD)                   | Brisbane, Gold Coast          | <i>To be appointed</i>   | <i>To be appointed</i> |
| Victoria (VIC)                     | Melbourne                     | <i>To be appointed</i>   | <i>To be appointed</i> |
| South Australia (SA)               | Adelaide                      | <i>To be appointed</i>   | <i>To be appointed</i> |
| Western Australia (WA)             | Perth                         | <i>To be appointed</i>   | <i>To be appointed</i> |
| Australian Capital Territory (ACT) | Canberra                      | <i>To be appointed</i>   | <i>To be appointed</i> |
| Tasmania (TAS)                     | Hobart                        | <i>Pending / forming</i> | <i>Pending</i>         |
| Northern Territory (NT)            | Darwin                        | <i>Pending / forming</i> | <i>Pending</i>         |

*Chapters with pending leadership are listed until formally appointed.*

### 6.2 State Chairperson — responsibilities

- Lead state association according to state constitution and national policies
- Organise local meetings, welfare response, sports days, cultural gatherings
- Maintain state membership list and local finances (separate from national accounts)
- Report quarterly to National Coordinator: events, membership, finances summary
- Appoint city coordinators within the state where helpful (Sydney lead, etc.)



## 6.3 Chapter Representative (REP) — responsibilities

- Attend National Chapter Council meetings (quarterly minimum)
- Voice state members' concerns and priorities at national level
- Communicate national decisions, calendar, and programs back to state members
- Vote on national policy, budget, and program approval where council has authority
- May be same person as Chairperson in small chapters, but separate roles preferred

## 6.4 Formation of new chapters

A new state or territory chapter may be recognised when:

1. A minimum number of committed members is documented (e.g. 15–25 families — set in constitution)
2. Interim Chair and REP are nominated
3. National Board approves recognition at a council meeting
4. Chapter adopts national branding and reporting standards

## 7. National Oversight / Advisory Council

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Following a non-executive **Oversight Council** model (as used by some diaspora organisations), Australia should establish a small council — typically 5–9 members — including:

- Founding members of early Australian Kalenjin / Gotabgaa groups
- Elders and cultural custodians (language, ceremony, heritage)
- Pastoral or community welfare advisors where appropriate
- Optional: professional advisors (legal, accounting) on advisory basis

**Powers:** advise only — no day-to-day executive authority. May review disputes, constitutional changes, and major cultural or ethical questions. Reports to National Board and AGM.

## 8. National Objectives

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The following objectives define the purpose of Gotabgaa Australia as an independent association. They draw on common community-organisation practice (and parallel wording seen on the [Gotabgaa International](#) website for reference only — **not as a binding affiliation**):

| Ref | Objective                                                                          | Australia application                                                                        |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A   | Raise, mobilise, and disburse funds for Gotabgaa objectives                        | National benevolence pool, scholarships, event sponsorship; transparent disbursement rules   |
| B   | Publish newsletters, brochures, and publications                                   | National website, email newsletter, social media, annual report                              |
| C   | Procure contributions via appeals, meetings, social and athletic events            | National cultural fete, Taunet Nelel coordination, fundraising campaigns                     |
| D   | Apply for and accept grants, donations, and assistance                             | Grants from community foundations, corporate sponsors, government programs (with compliance) |
| E   | Organise social, educational, and health-promoting activities                      | Youth mentorship, settlement support, health awareness with state chapters                   |
| F   | Promote organisations with similar objectives                                      | Partnerships with African-Australian networks, Kenyan diaspora groups                        |
| G   | Arrangements with institutional and governmental bodies                            | Where appropriate — settlement services, multicultural councils (non-partisan)               |
| H   | Establish healthcare, educational, or community institutions (with member consent) | Long-term: scholarship fund, community centre aspirations — majority vote required           |
| I   | Non-political and non-partisan; activities within stated objectives                | <b>Mandatory</b> for all national and state officers and programs                            |

## 9. Division of Responsibilities: National vs State

| Function                | National (Gotabgaa Australia)                                        | State chapter                                                            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Brand & website         | Owns gotabgaa-australia.org; national logo; independence statement   | May use national brand; local social pages with national guidelines      |
| Membership              | National register or federated register; Australian membership rules | Local enrolment, welfare eligibility, local dues if any                  |
| Events                  | National calendar; Taunet Nelel branding; avoids date clashes        | Local BBQs, sports days, AGMs, city meetups                              |
| Benevolence             | National fund rules; pooling under Australian policy                 | First response to local hardship; referrals to national fund             |
| Education / youth       | National mentorship framework; scholarship policy                    | Local student support, school visits, career panels                      |
| Finance                 | National bank account; audited national reports                      | State accounts; report summaries to national treasurer                   |
| Leadership elections    | National board elections at national AGM                             | State chair/REP elections at state AGMs                                  |
| External representation | Official national voice; Australian partners and media               | State reps may join national forums; optional guest attendance elsewhere |
| Disputes                | Escalation body; oversight council advisory role                     | Initial resolution at state level                                        |

**Rule of thumb:** If the activity primarily serves members in one state, the state chapter leads. If it serves members across states or represents Australia externally, national leads.

## 10. Programs & Events Coordination

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### 10.1 National programs

- **Education & mentorship** — adapting to Australian schools and workplaces
- **Benevolence fund** — member-supported assistance during loss or hardship
- **Community outreach** — settlement, health awareness, African-Australian partnerships
- **Cultural fete / Taunet Nelel** — annual celebration of Kalenjin heritage

### 10.2 Events calendar governance

1. States propose dates to National Coordinator by quarterly deadline
2. National publishes consolidated calendar on website
3. Major national events (e.g. annual cultural gathering) receive national branding and board approval
4. Conflicting dates resolved by Chapter Council vote if needed

### 10.3 Taunet Nelel and cross-state celebrations

Events such as Taunet Nelel may rotate host state annually or be coordinated as a national program with a host chapter — national sets standards (cultural authenticity, safety, finances); host state executes logistics.

## 11. Finance, Benevolence & Fundraising

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### 11.1 Two-tier financial model

- **State accounts:** local donations, local event revenue, local welfare disbursement
- **National accounts:** national campaigns, scholarships, national event surplus

Never commingle without documented transfer and dual approval (state treasurer + national treasurer).

### 11.2 Benevolence workflow (recommended)

1. Member in need contacts state chapter
2. State welfare lead assesses and may approve local support from state fund

3. If amount exceeds state threshold, state refers to national benevolence committee
4. National treasurer disburses per Australian benevolence policy; Secretary General records decision

### 11.3 Transparency

- Annual financial summary published at AGM (national + aggregated state)
- Internal audit or external review every 2–3 years for national accounts
- Public donation page with clear purpose statements

## 12. Membership Model

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### 12.1 Categories (suggested)

| Category         | Description                                                   |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Full member      | Kalenjin individual or family; voting rights in state chapter |
| Associate member | Spouse, friend, supporter; non-voting or limited voting       |
| Youth member     | Under 18; programs access; transitions to full at 18          |

### 12.2 Registration

Membership is with **Gotabgaa Australia** (national and/or state chapter as defined in the constitution). Participation in any other organisation — including Gotabgaa International (USA) — is separate and voluntary; it does not confer rights or obligations within Gotabgaa Australia unless separately documented.

The National Secretary General maintains clarity on which register applies for voting, welfare, and program eligibility within Australia.

## 13. Communications, Brand & Digital Presence

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- **National owns:** website, primary email (e.g. info@gotabgaaaustralia.org), national social links
- **States may operate:** state Facebook/WhatsApp groups with national logo usage guidelines
- **Tagline:** Unity • Heritage • Excellence (consistent everywhere)
- **Identity line:** "Gotabgaa Australia — an independent Australian association" (not an affiliate of any foreign body)

- **Press & media:** National President or designated spokesperson only

## 14. Independent Status & Gotabgaa International (Reference)

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**Important:** Gotabgaa Australia is **not** an affiliate, chapter, or subsidiary of Gotabgaa International (USA). It is a distinct association with its own leadership, constitution, finances, and programs. It operates independently.

### 14.1 What independence means

- Gotabgaa Australia's board is accountable to its members and Australian law — not to GI
- National funds are held and spent under Australian policies only
- Website, logo, and public statements must not imply GI ownership or control
- Constitutional changes require Australian AGM approval — not GI approval

### 14.2 Shared heritage, separate organisations

Both names reflect Kalenjin diaspora community work. Members may know people in both networks. [Gotabgaa International](#) remains a separate US entity. Any cooperation (e.g. attending a cultural event as guests) is **optional** and must be agreed by the National Board case by case — never assumed.

### 14.3 External representation

The National President (or board-appointed delegate) represents **Gotabgaa Australia only** in media, government, and partner meetings. State REPs represent their chapters at national council. No officer is automatically a representative of Gotabgaa International.

## 15. Governance, Elections & Meetings

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### 15.1 Meeting cadence (recommended)

| Meeting                  | Frequency               | Attendees                                |
|--------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| National Board meeting   | Monthly (or bi-monthly) | Board officers                           |
| National Chapter Council | Quarterly               | All state Chairs + REPs + board          |
| National AGM             | Annual                  | All members; elections; financial report |
| State AGM                | Annual                  | State members; state elections           |
| Oversight Council        | Bi-annual               | Advisors + board (portion)               |

## 15.2 Quorum and voting

- Board quorum: majority of officers (e.g. 3 of 5)
- Chapter Council quorum: majority of recognised chapters represented
- Constitutional changes: supermajority (e.g. 66%) at AGM with 30-day notice
- Financial thresholds for benevolence: defined in policy, not ad hoc

## 16. Dispute Resolution & Conduct

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1. **Stage 1:** Direct discussion at state level (Chair + parties)
2. **Stage 2:** State REP escalates to National Vice President / Coordinator
3. **Stage 3:** National Board hearing; Oversight Council advisory input
4. **Stage 4:** External mediation or legal advice if required under Australian law

All officers sign a **code of conduct**: respect, confidentiality for welfare cases, no political campaigning under Gotabgaa name, financial honesty, cultural sensitivity.



## 17. Implementation Roadmap

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| Phase                            | Timeline       | Actions                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Phase 1 —<br/>Foundation</b>  | 0–3<br>months  | Draft constitution; confirm state chapter list; interim national board; launch national website; clarify independent status publicly |
| <b>Phase 2 —<br/>Recognition</b> | 3–6<br>months  | Appoint/confirm all state Chairs and REPs; first Chapter Council meeting; publish leadership on website; open national membership    |
| <b>Phase 3 —<br/>Programs</b>    | 6–12<br>months | Launch benevolence policy; national events calendar; education/mentorship pilot; first national AGM                                  |
| <b>Phase 4 —<br/>Maturity</b>    | 12+<br>months  | Oversight Council seated; financial audit; expand TAS/NT chapters if ready                                                           |

## 18. Australian Legal & Regulatory Context

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This section is guidance for leadership planning — not legal advice. Consult an Australian solicitor and accountant before incorporation, fundraising, or registering as a charity.

### 18.1 Common structural options

| Option                                  | Description                                                               | Typical use for Gotabgaa Australia                                |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Unincorporated federation</b>        | National body coordinates; states remain separate entities                | Fast start while states already exist; lower national setup cost  |
| <b>Incorporated association (state)</b> | Registered under state law (e.g. NSW, QLD Associations Incorporation Act) | Each state chapter or one “lead” state entity as national vehicle |
| <b>Company limited by guarantee</b>     | ACNC-registered charity possible; directors, constitution                 | National body with formal governance and public donations         |
| <b>Auspecting</b>                       | Operate programs under an established charity’s umbrella                  | Short-term grants or events before full incorporation             |

### 18.2 Regulatory considerations

- **ACNC** — if seeking tax-deductible donations, charity registration and ongoing reporting apply
- **Fundraising laws** — vary by state; national campaigns may need multi-state compliance
- **Privacy Act** — membership databases and welfare cases require data protection policies
- **Working with children** — youth programs may require background checks per state law
- **Insurance** — public liability for events; directors’ insurance if incorporated

### 18.3 Recommended governance documents

1. National constitution (objects, membership, elections, finance, dissolution)
2. National–state chapter MOU (see Section 24)
3. Benevolence fund policy and disbursement rules
4. Code of conduct and conflict-of-interest register
5. Financial management policy (two signatories, expense limits, audit cycle)
6. Privacy and welfare confidentiality policy

## 19. Chapter Structure Reference (Gotabgaa International — USA, separate org)

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The US-based [Gotabgaa International](#) website lists chapters with **Chairperson** and **Chapter REP**. Gotabgaa Australia uses a similar *structural* pattern for its own state chapters — but remains **fully independent** with no reporting or governance link to that organisation.

### 19.1 US organisation leadership (reference only — not our governance)

| Role                       | Name (on GI website — USA) |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| Board President            | Janeth Ruto                |
| Board Vice President       | Vincent Sumbaei            |
| Board Secretary General    | Esly Kania                 |
| Board National Coordinator | Abraham Bitok              |
| Board Treasurer            | Vincent Ng'eno             |

### 19.2 US oversight council (reference only)

Prof. John Rugut, Amb. Peter Rono, Dr. Anthony Rono, Veronica Metto, David Mugun — founders and senior advisors.

### 19.3 Sample US chapter pattern (Chair + REP)

| Chapter       | Chairperson        | Chapter REP    |
|---------------|--------------------|----------------|
| Dallas        | Barnabas Kirui     | Victir Rotich  |
| Houston       | Judy Boit          | Lilly Telle    |
| Washington DC | Simon Kelum        | David Koech    |
| Ohio          | Samson Kipchirchir | Chris Kuchurei |
| Minnesota     | Zadok Nampala      | Philemon Too   |

*Full GI chapter list: Alabama, Arizona, California, Colorado, Dallas, Houston, Illinois, Iowa, Kansas City, Minnesota, North Carolina, Ohio, Washington DC, Wichita.*

### **19.3 Australia's own structure**

**Gotabgaa Australia National Board** governs the independent national association. **State chapters** (NSW, QLD, VIC, SA, WA, ACT, TAS, NT) each have Chair + REP listed on the national website. City groups operate under state chapters.

## 20. National Programs — Detailed Operating Model

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### 20.1 Education & mentorship

| Element    | National                                                     | State                                          |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Purpose    | National education framework                                 | Local student and newcomer support             |
| Activities | Scholarship policy, mentor registry, career panels (virtual) | School visits, tutoring, workplace orientation |
| Lead       | National Coordinator + education subcommittee                | State youth/education lead                     |
| Metrics    | Scholarships awarded, mentors active, events held            | Students supported per quarter                 |

### 20.2 Benevolence fund

| Element                 | Detail                                                                                 |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Australia national pool | Supplementary fund for cases exceeding state capacity; Australian rules only           |
| Eligibility             | Defined in policy: membership status, relationship to deceased/hardship, documentation |
| Approval tiers          | State threshold (e.g. up to \$X); national committee above threshold                   |
| Confidentiality         | Welfare cases never discussed in open meetings; Secretary General records decisions    |

### 20.3 Community outreach

- Settlement support for new arrivals (referrals to services, welcome networks)
- Health awareness (mental health, chronic disease, men's/women's health forums)
- Partnerships with African-Australian organisations and multicultural councils
- Volunteer roster managed at state level; national coordinates cross-state campaigns

### 20.4 Cultural fete / Taunet Nelel

- **National:** brand standards, date selection, national publicity
- **Host state:** venue, logistics, local permits, on-ground volunteers
- **Content:** traditional music, dance, storytelling, cuisine, games — all generations
- **Rotation:** host state rotates annually or biennially by Chapter Council agreement

## 21. Communications Protocol Matrix

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| Topic                               | Who speaks                              | Channel                         | Notes                               |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| National policy / public statements | National President or delegate          | Website, email, press           | Single voice for Gotabgaa Australia |
| State event announcement            | State Chair or REP                      | State social, national calendar | Use national logo guidelines        |
| Welfare request                     | State welfare lead                      | Private phone/email             | Never public social media           |
| Financial appeal                    | National Treasurer                      | Email, website donate page      | Clear purpose and accountability    |
| Youth programs                      | National Coordinator + state youth lead | Email, WhatsApp groups          | Parental consent for minors         |
| Dispute or conduct issue            | National VP or Secretary General        | Private correspondence          | No public naming without process    |
| Media interview                     | National President only                 | Press                           | Board briefs talking points         |

## 22. KPIs & Success Measures

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Review annually at AGM. Targets should be set by leadership — examples below:

| Area             | Example KPI                                     | Target (illustrative)     |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Chapters         | Recognised states with Chair + REP appointed    | 6+ within 12 months       |
| Membership       | Registered families nationally                  | Growth 10–15% YoY         |
| Events           | Cross-state events on national calendar         | 10+ per year              |
| Benevolence      | Cases supported; average response time          | < 7 days initial response |
| Education        | Mentors active; scholarships disbursed          | Set per budget            |
| Annual reporting | AGM report to members published                 | 100% on time              |
| Finance          | Audit completed; AGM financial report published | Every 2–3 years audit     |
| Digital          | Website updated; state leadership listed        | Quarterly refresh         |

## 23. Risks, Pitfalls & Mitigations

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| Risk                              | Impact                     | Mitigation                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| National duplicates state events  | Low attendance, resentment | National calendar; Chapter Council approval for major dates |
| Two treasurers, one pot of money  | Disputes, fraud risk       | Separate accounts; documented transfers; dual approval      |
| Strong state resists national     | Split community            | MOU clarifying roles; REP voice on council; no power grab   |
| Political use of Gotabgaa name    | Reputation, legal risk     | Non-partisan objective enforced; code of conduct            |
| Welfare gossip                    | Harm to families           | Confidentiality policy; private channels only               |
| Leadership stagnation             | Low engagement             | Term limits; youth pipeline; staggered elections            |
| Website shows only national faces | States feel invisible      | Publish full state chapter table on website                 |
| No legal entity for donations     | Cannot fundraise formally  | Phase legal incorporation per Section 18                    |

## 24. Sample National–State Chapter MOU Outline

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Short memorandum between **Gotabgaa Australia (national)** and **[State] Chapter**:

1. **Purpose:** mutual recognition and cooperation within Gotabgaa Australia
2. **Recognition:** state chapter acknowledged as an official chapter of Gotabgaa Australia in [State]
3. **Autonomy:** state retains local constitution, elections, local accounts subject to reporting
4. **Branding:** use of national logo and tagline per brand guidelines
5. **Reporting:** quarterly report to National Coordinator; annual summary to AGM
6. **Finance:** state funds remain state-owned; national pooling only by documented transfer
7. **Programs:** participation in national programs voluntary unless AGM/council mandates



8. **Representation:** Chair and REP attend Chapter Council; REP is voting member where applicable
9. **Disputes:** escalation per Section 16 of this framework
10. **Term:** MOU renewable annually; termination with 90-day notice and member communication
11. **Signatures:** National President, National Secretary General, State Chair, State REP

## 25. Website & Public Representation

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Recommended public structure for the independent national association:

- **About:** mission, vision, objectives, non-partisan statement, independent status
- **Leadership:** National Board + State Chapters table (Chair + REP names)
- **Programs:** education, benevolence, outreach, cultural fete
- **Events:** national calendar + links to state activities
- **Contact:** national email; state contact routing optional

## 26. Appendix: Templates & Checklists

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### 26.1 Quarterly state report (to National Coordinator)

- Chapter name and reporting period
- Chair and REP names
- Membership count (full / associate / youth)
- Events held (date, title, attendance estimate)
- Welfare cases supported (summary only — no private details)
- Financial summary: income, expenditure, balance
- Challenges and support needed from national
- Proposed events for next quarter

### 26.2 New chapter recognition checklist

- ☐ Minimum membership threshold met
- ☐ Interim Chair and REP named
- ☐ State constitution or adoption of national template
- ☐ Bank account or agreed financial arrangement
- ☐ National Board vote recorded
- ☐ Listed on website leadership page
- ☐ Independent status stated on website and materials

### 26.3 National AGM agenda (template)

1. Welcome and acknowledgment of country
2. Minutes of previous AGM
3. President's report
4. Treasurer's report and budget approval
5. Coordinator's program report
6. State chapter highlights (each REP, 5 minutes)
7. Elections for vacant board positions
8. Constitutional amendments (if any)
9. General business and close

## 26.4 Document control

|                |                                                                                 |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document title | Gotabgaa Australia — National Structure & Governance Framework                  |
| Version        | 1.2                                                                             |
| Change note    | Clarified independent status — not affiliated with Gotabgaa International (USA) |
| Date           | June 2026                                                                       |
| Status         | Working document for leadership review                                          |
| Next review    | After first National Chapter Council meeting                                    |
| Reference      | <a href="#">Gotabgaa International About Us</a>                                 |

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